

Rainbow's End

A NOVEL.

By REX BEACH

Author of "The Iron Trail," "The Spoilers," "Heart of the Sunset," etc.

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CHAPTER XX.

Morin, the Fisherman.

When Rosa Varona regained consciousness sufficiently to understand what had happened she proved herself a person of no little self-control. It was she, in fact, who first voiced the fear that Cobo dead was scarcely less a menace than Cobo alive.

"What are we going to do with him?" she inquired.

Jacket, too, appreciated the dangers of the situation. "We must get rid of him quickly," said he, "for his men are close by; he will be missed and there will be a search."

"I don't intend to make him a present of that treasure," O'Reilly said, grimly. "It is our only salvation."

"But how are we going to hide him?" Jacket inquired. "One might as well try to conceal a church; oxen couldn't hold him out of that hole."

"Precisely! He has made our work easy for us. We can't take more than a small part of the money with us, anyhow; the rest will have to lie here until the war is over. Well! We shall leave Cobo on guard over what remains!"

Jacket was immensely pleased with this idea, once he had grasped it. "What could be better?" he cried. "The man's spirit is evil enough to frighten people away and we will drop stones upon him, so that he can learn the taste of his own medicine. It suits me exactly to think of Colonel Cobo strutting on his head in a hole in the ground for the rest of eternity!"

O'Reilly was by this time suffering the full reaction from the events of the past half-hour and he was nearer exhaustion than he dreamed, but, conquering his repugnance for his uncapable task, he lowered himself once more into the well. His arms were weak, however, and his fingers numb, so he fell rather than slid the length of the rope. He managed to open the door of the treasure chamber, then entered and loaded his pockets with gold. He sent up the jewel box at the end of the rope, dragged the body of Cobo into



Dragged the Body of Cobo into the Cave.

the cave, then wedged the barricade back into place. It required the combined strength of Rosa and Jacket to help him the last few feet of his climb.

"Now fetch stones, rubbish, anything—and throw it in there," he gasped.

The boy and the girl fell to with a will, and after a time Johnnie joined them. Slowly, laboriously, the three of them carried debris from the edge of the quarry and bricks from the ruined house; they scraped up armfuls of leaves and trash—anything, in fact, which would serve to raise the bottom of the shaft and conceal the entrance to their enemy's resting place. It was slow work, but O'Reilly kept them at it until they were ready to drop. Daylight overtook them at their task.

They were weak, sick, deadly tired; they could barely shuffle a few yards at a time when they finally reached Asensio's hut; nevertheless there was hope in their hearts, for O'Reilly's ragged clothes sagged with the weight of gold pieces and the little metal box he carried was heavy. Nor were they greatly concerned about the safety of the treasure they had left behind, for the entrance to the cavern lay deeply buried, and Cobo, the guerrilla, stood guard over the chests of plate and the casks of coin.

Evangelina, vastly bewildered at the sight of the coin which was forced into her palm, went for food and spent most of the day in cooking it. The treasure-hunters alternately slept and ate. It was not until well along toward evening that Rosa and O'Reilly felt any desire to take stock of the contents of that jewel box, but finally, with heads together and with backs to the door of the bohio, they made a furtive examination. They found emeralds and sapphires the value of which they did not attempt to estimate; and, besides these, a miscellaneous assortment of semiprecious stones.

O'Reilly realized vaguely that he held in his lap a fortune greater than his wildest dreams had ever compassed. These were the jewels of a rajah. It seemed incredible that this ragged girl beside him was a regal heiress, the possessor of a treasure such as kings might envy. After a time he realized that the mere possession of these gems constituted a new and overwhelming menace.

Morning found all hands more nearly rational and feeling the first gnawings of a healthy hunger. Eren Asensio confessed to a quite miraculous improvement. While Evangelina prepared breakfast the lovers agreed upon a story to explain the origin of that mysterious gold piece, and later Johnnie warned Jacket for a second time to keep his tongue between his teeth.

Jacket nodded his complete comprehension. "Sure! All Spaniards are robbers and they'd kill us for a peso. Yes, and the pacificos are no better. I tell you we need to get out of this place."

"I intend to arrange it at once, but—the sight of those jewels has frightened me. If we are searched—if we are even suspected—I'm wondering if Rosa can endure the hardships we'll encounter when, or if, we get away."

"Exactly what I was thinking. I've been considering another plan. I told you about my friend at the market. Well, he is a miserable Spaniard, but he has a son in the manigua."

"One of us?" Johnnie was surprised.

"Yes. The old fellow owns a volandra in which he brings charcoal from the eastward twice a month. He might take us out of here—on his schooner."

"How well does he like you?"

"Oh, we are like two thieves."

"After a period of thought O'Reilly said, 'Take me to him, and remember I'm your brother Juan.'"

The Matanzas market did not present a scene of great activity when the two friends slunk into it. Like most Spanish markets, the building was far from clean and housed odors unpleasant even to starving people. In the smallest section, at one of the fish stalls, Jacket accosted a villainous old brigand in a rough Gallego cap, baggy blouse and trousers, and straw sandals.

"Good day, my captain," he cried, cheerily.

The Spaniard raised his head, scowled ferociously, then waved a long, thin-bladed knife in menacing fashion. "Aha! So there you are, robber! Be off now before I slit your greedy little belly! Didn't I promise to give you to the soldiers if you came back to bother me?"

Jacket was unabashed by this hostile reception. He grinned broadly and with an impudent eye he scanned the empty premises.

"Where is my little fish?" he demanded. "As I live, I believe you have sold it! What a miser! For the sake of another centavo you would see me starve? There's a heart for you! Come, give me my fish! Or must I lie down and die before your very eyes to prove my hunger?"

"What a nuisance!" grumbled the marketman. He reached into a basket and flung a mackerel upon the table. "There! I saved it for you, and sent the good women of Matanzas away empty-handed. But it is the very last Annoy me again and I shall open you with my knife and put salt on you."

"Ah! You are my good captain!"

Jacket cried in triumph, possessing himself of the prize. "Where would I have been but for you? Turning to O'Reilly, who had looked on from a distance, he said, 'Captain Morin, this is that brother Juan of whom I have told you.'"

Morin smiled at Johnnie and extended his dirty palm. "The little fellow can speak the truth when he wishes, it seems. I began to doubt that he had a brother. What a boy, eh?"

"You have a son with the insurgents too?"

"Yes. The fisherman cast a furtive glance over his shoulder.

"Why don't you go and fight by his side?" Jacket demanded.

"God forbid!" Morin dug up his hands. "I'm a loyal subject."

"Well, we are going back to fight. We are going to escape and join some more!" Jacket made the announcement calmly.

"S-sh! What talk!" Morin was in a nervous panic lest they be overheard. "As if anybody could escape from Matanzas! What made you come here if you are so eager to fight?"

"I'll tell you," O'Reilly assumed direction of the conversation. "There are three of us brothers, we two and Esteban, a pretty little fellow. He was captured by Cobo's men and driven in and we came to find him. But he is sick—dying—"

"Of course. They're all dying—the poor people! It is terrible."

"We—" O'Reilly faltered slightly so much hung upon the manner in which Morin would take what he was about to say. "We want to get him out of here—we must do so, or we'll lose him. Will you help us?"

"I? In heaven's name, how?"

"By taking us away in your charcoal schooner."

"You're mad!" Morin cast another apprehensive look over his shoulder.

"I'm a poor man. All I have is my two boats, the vivero, which brings fish, and the volandra, which sails with charcoal. Do you think I'd forfeit them and my life for strangers?"

O'Reilly leaned closer. "You say you're a poor man. I will pay you well."

Morin eyed the ragged speaker scornfully; it was plain that he put no faith in such a promise, and so O'Reilly took a piece of gold from his pocket, at sight of which the fisherman started.

"I, too, am a poor man, but I'm willing to buy freedom for my little brothers and myself."

"How many coins like that have you?"

"Um—more than one; enough to pay you for several cargoes of coal."

"For the sake of Miguelito," Jacket urged. "Caramba! What a hard-hearted father begot that boy!"

"Hush!" The fisherman was scowling. To O'Reilly he said, "You do wrong to tempt a poor man."

"My brother Esteban is sick. He is a frail little lad with a crooked back. God will reward you."

"Perhaps! But how much will you pay?"

"Ten Spanish sovereigns like this—all that I have."

"No! It is not enough."

O'Reilly took Jacket's hand and turned away. "I'm sorry," he said.

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with I might offer you more." He had taken several steps before Morin halted him.

"Come back tomorrow," the fisherman cried, crossly. "We will try to talk like sensible people."

The brothers Villar were back at Morin's fish stand on the following afternoon and they returned daily thereafter until they at last prevailed over the Spaniard's fears and won his promise of assistance. That much accomplished, they made several cautious purchases, a coat here, a shirt there, a pair of trousers in another place, until they had assembled a complete boy's outfit of clothing.

At first Rosa refused absolutely to desert her two faithful negro friends and O'Reilly won her consent to consider his plan of escape only after he had put the matter squarely up to Asensio and his wife and after both had refused to enter into it.

Then, and not until then, did Rosa begin her preparations. First she had Evangelina cut her hair, a sacrifice that wrung sighs and tears and loud lamentations from the black woman, after which she altered the suit of boy's clothing to fit her figure, or rather to conceal it.

When at last she put it on for O'Reilly's approval she was very shy, very



"My Dear, You'll Never Do," He Told Her.

self-conscious, and so altogether unboylike that he shook his head positively.

"My dear, you'll never do," he told her. "You are altogether too pretty."

"But wait until I put that hideous bump upon my back and stain my face, then you will see how ugly I can look."

"Perhaps," he said, doubtfully. A moment, then his frown lightened. "You give me a thought," said he. "You shall wear the jewels."

"Wear them? How?"

"On your back, in that very bump. It will be the safest possible way to conceal them."

Rosa clasped her hands in delight. "Why, of course! It is the very thing. Wait until I show you."

Profiting by her first moment alone—Evangelina and her husband being still in ignorance of the contents of the treasure box—Rosa made a bundle out of the jewels and trinkets and fastened it securely inside her coat. After a few experiments she adjusted it to her liking, then called O'Reilly once more. This time he was better satisfied.

An application of Evangelina's stain to darken her face, a few tatters and a liberal application of dirt to the suit, and he declared that Rosa would pass anywhere as a boy.

There came a night when the three of them bade good-by to their black companions and slipped away across the city to that section known as Pueblo Nuevo, then followed the road along the water front until they found shelter within the shadows of a rickety structure which had once served as a bath house.

The refugees waited a long time; they were beginning to fear that old Morin's nerve had weakened at the eleventh hour, when they beheld a skiff approaching the shore. It glided closer, entered the shade of the bath house, then a voice cried:

"Pset! You are there? It was Morin himself."

Hastily the three piled aboard. Morin bent to his oars and the skiff shot out. "You were not observed?" he inquired.

"No."

Morin rowed in silence for a time.

"When do you sail?" O'Reilly asked.

"At dawn, God permitting. You will have to remain hidden and you mustn't even breathe."

He brought the skiff alongside a battered old schooner and his passengers clambered aboard. There was a tiny cabin aft and on it, sheltered from the night dew by a loose fold of the mainsail, were two sleeping men. The newcomers followed Morin down into the evil little cabin, where he warned them in a hoarse whisper:

"Not a sound, mind you. If anyone comes aboard, you must shift for yourselves. Creep into the hold and hide. Of course, if we are searched—"

He muttered something, then groped his way out on deck, and closed the hatch behind him.

Now that they had actually embarked upon this enterprise and the girl had given herself entirely into his hands, now that an imminent peril encompassed them both, Johnnie felt that Rosa belonged to him more absolutely, more completely, than at any time heretofore, so he held her close. Rosa lay relaxed against her lover's shoulder and in halting murmurs, interrupted many times by caresses, she told O'Reilly of her need for him, and her utter happiness. It was the fullest hour of their lives.

With daylight, Morin routed out his men. There was a sleepy muttering, the patter of bare feet upon the deck above, then the creak of blocks as the sails were raised. A few moments, then there came a hail which brought their hearts into their throats. Morin himself answered the call.

"Good morning, countryman! Have you caught any of those accursed filibusters since I saw you last? So? Cayo

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Playwright Who Helped to End Actors' Strike



Augustus Thomas

After the striking New York actors had rejected terms offered by the Producing Managers Association and it seemed that the strike would go on indefinitely, Augustus Thomas, head of the playwrights' mediation committee, brought manager and actor together again. The result is the settlement of the strike which had kept Broadway theatres darkened for about a month.

Romano, eh? What have I aboard?" Morin laughed loudly. "You know very well—cannon and shot for the rebels, of course. Will you look?"

"Then a cup of coffee perhaps?"

O'Reilly peeped through a dirt-stained cabin window and saw that the volandra was slipping past the stern of the ironclad, so he withdrew his head quickly.

Of course this was but one danger past and there were many more ahead, for Morin's schooner was liable to be stopped by any of the numerous patrol boats on duty to the eastward. Nevertheless, when an anxious hour had gone by and she was well toward the harbor mouth, the refugees told one another they were safe.

(Continued in next issue.)

CROWDS IN CHICAGO CHEER ANTI LEAGUERS

CHICAGO, Sept. 11.—Senators William Borah of Idaho, Hiram Johnson of California and Medill McCormick of Illinois, who in addresses before a crowd estimated at 15,000 here last night assailed President Wilson and the League of Nations in such biting words that the enthusiasm of the crowd approached hysteria, will be asked to return to Chicago within the next 10 days to repeat their talks against the League of Nations and the Versailles treaty, according to plans under way today.

Senator Johnson, attacking the sending of American soldiers to Siberia, worked the crowd into a frenzy. He was repeatedly interrupted with cries of "Impeach him."

Not content with cheering, men and women left their seats in the auditorium and danced down the aisles of the theatre throwing their hats and programs into the air and at times delaying the speakers for several minutes.

Thousands of persons, unable to force their way into the building, waited on the outside until after the meeting, then refused to leave the scene until after the senators had each delivered short addresses from the fire escapes of the building.

MAJOR GENERAL WOOD MAY RESIGN OFFICE TO SEEK PRESIDENCY

NEW YORK, Sept. 13.—Major General Leonard Wood today refused to discuss persistent reports that he would resign his army office within a few days to become an active candidate for the republican presidential nomination. The report was first spread by politicians who talked to General Wood when he reached New York Thursday.

General Wood feels, they said, that it would be disloyal for him to remain in the army and at the same time strive to succeed President Wilson, his commander in chief.

These embassies, it is said, have reported that Governor Lowden, of Illinois, who is also mentioned as a candidate, is willing to accept the vice presidency should Wood be nominated.

COLONEL DREYFUS OF FRENCH FAME IS GIVEN LEGION OF HONOR

PARIS, Sept. 15.—Lieutenant Colonel Alfred Dreyfus was decorated Friday as an officer in the Legion of Honor, in recognition of his war service. Alfred Dreyfus was once convicted of treason and sentenced to Devil's Island but later pardoned by the government.

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PORTLAND FLOURING MILL OPERATIVES STRIKE; MILLS CLOSE

PORTLAND, Sept. 12.—Portland flour mills were suddenly forced to suspend operations at 10 o'clock Thursday, when workmen employed on the first of three shifts left their places in a general strike of grain handlers and mill operators, according to the statement of mill officials, who disclaim knowledge of any reason for the action.

Early this month the workmen, said not to include those actually engaged in the manufacture of the flour, asked the millers to confer with a committee of three union men with a view of recognizing the union organization. This conference was refused by the millers and nothing more is said to have been heard from the subject until the strike was called today.

Millers say they have not estimated the number of men in the strike and will not be able to do so until they determine what part of the other two shifts take part in the walkout.

The strike is directed by the Flour and Cereal Workers union No. 38-4, of which L. J. Steinfeld is secretary. In a statement Steinfeld declared the millers had spurned the union committee's request for a conference and that this action, characterized as arrogant, led directly to the walkout. It was the plan of the union to present demands for recognition and for the closed shop principle.

10000 ATTEND FIRST DAY OF GRESHAM FAIR; IS RECORD BREAKER

GRESHAM, Sept. 16.—"It was the greatest opening day ever known in the history of the Multnomah County fair," declared General Manager C. D. Minton yesterday, "and this is the 13th fair we have held here. I cannot begin to say how delighted I am."

The perfect weather combined with the fact that President Wilson was to be a "fair" visitor were two of the outstanding factors in bringing out the 10,000 people who came from all parts of the state to "get a glimpse" of the president, and his wife, and to see the scores of wonderful exhibits tastefully arranged in the numerous buildings located all over the spacious grounds.

FEELING BETWEEN ROUMANIA AND ALLIES GROWS MORE FRIENDLY

PARIS, Sept. 15.—The situation between Roumania and the entente appears to be brighter. A cordial meeting was held by Stephen Pichon, French foreign minister, and Nicholas Misu, Roumanian representative in Paris, and M. Vade, one of the Roumanian peace delegation, Saturday. The Roumanians expressed the desire of Roumania to safeguard their country's national dignity, but to uphold her avowed intention to remain on friendly relations with the entente.

In China every business man has a shop name and a private name, and among his family and acquaintances he is known by the latter.

President as His Train Was Leaving St. Louis



President Wilson

This unusual photograph of President Wilson was taken at St. Louis during his speechmaking tour in support of the league of Nations. He is seen here saying goodbye to friends and admirers from the rear platform of his special train.

HEROISM OF FATHER TO BE REWARDED BY AID GIVEN CHILDREN

BOSTON, Sept. 15.—Believing that the children of Mr. and Mrs. William Tanner are the innocent victims of a horrible calamity no matter what the opinion of the public may be as to their father's action, Mrs. Samuel Plame Jr. of 1254 Commonwealth avenue, Allston, has started a \$100,000 fund for them with a contribution of \$1000.

"The future of the children," she said, "it seems to me is a far more practical question than the academic one as to whether their father's action was a proper one."

CHICAGO, Sept. 15.—The three Tanner children, Lyman, William and Helen, whose mother and father were killed by a train in Hubbards woods, will live—at least for the present—with their aunt, Mrs. Josephine C. Cassidy, and their grandmother, Mrs. Carrie G. Chatterly. This was decided today by Judge Bowles in the juvenile court, when he dismissed a petition of dependency filed by representatives of the Illinois Children's Home and Aid Society.

If the appetite of a man were as great as that of a sparrow in proportion to his size, he would eat a whole sheep at one sitting.

GERMAN SUBMARINE WITH RECORD WILL VISIT IN PORTLAND

PORTLAND, Sept. 12.—Portland is to see and inspect a genuine German U-boat on October 1-4, according to advices received yesterday by Mayor Baker from the San Pedro naval base. The ex-German submarine, U-88, now in command of Lieutenant Commander J. L. Nielson, is of the one-gun, 10-ton type, and carries a crew of 30.

With the U-88 comes as evil a machine of Hun sea-outrages as could be imagined. She left Germany June 1, 1918. Steaming north, she lay off the east coast of England, sinking two British steamers before returning to the Zeebrugge base. There she was made a unit of the Flanders flotilla. Between June 20 and July 1 she sent six steamers and their innocent victims to a watery grave.

She was heard of next in Tor bay on September 12, where in one week she torpedoed and sank four vessels. She was surrendered to the allies at Harwich November 27.

CAT TAKES TRIP IN AIRPLANE AT END OF SIX-FOOT TOW LINE

EUGENE, Sept. 12.—Trailing through the ether attached to the end of a six-foot tow